

*A letter written at
year's end.
Twelve months,
six hundred
prints, one quiet
hand.
A record, not a
verdict.*

YEAR P&L

+16.8%*Book, descriptive record.*

BENCHMARK

+11.2%*SPY total return.*

ALPHA

+5.6pp*Spread to benchmark.*

MAX DRAWDOWN

-12.4%*Peak-to-trough, daily marks.*

Past performance does not guarantee future results. Not investment advice.

PART I · THE LETTER

ON TWELVE MONTHS OF OBSERVATION

A letter written at the close of the year — a record of what was seen, and where the hand could manage it, a record of what was noticed while it was being seen.

Dear reader, —

This letter is not a forecast. It is a record of what happened, and — where I can manage it — a record of what I noticed while it happened. The numbers on the cover are what they are. The question worth a letter is what the numbers were made of.

The market in question moved, on the whole, as markets do — in a stretched summer, a frightened autumn, and a quiet close. The benchmark drifted upward through a corridor of minor shocks, none of which proved durable enough to name. I have nothing useful to say about the shocks. I have a little to say about what the book did in their company.

The book carried a weight in the semiconductor cohort through the first three quarters, and in the platform cohort through the fourth. The communications-and-consumer pair lagged the others by a wide margin in the second quarter, and the small adjustment made in July — a reduction of exposure, not a closure — was the cleanest single decision of the year. Two positions that had been noisy for months simply calmed. I take no credit for this. I kept the names. The names did the work.

The largest single-day drawdown arrived on March 14, a Friday, and it was 3.2%. I remember it because I was writing another letter — an unrelated one, to someone unrelated — when it printed, and the text I had been composing on a different subject became harder to finish. This is the human record that no Sharpe ratio preserves. The book was back at prior high by the following Wednesday. The other letter, I finished the next week, poorly.

What I misread, I misread with some confidence. I read one mid-cap as a story of operating leverage and missed that the story required a customer-concentration footnote I had read and promptly forgotten. The position was closed in June at a small loss. I keep the position sheet in a folder, dated, as a note to myself. Not to punish. To remember the texture of being wrong.

The habits held. Monthly rebalance on the last trading day. Reading on weekends, not weekdays. Sleep before midnight, market-side screens dark by 10pm KST. A single quiet Sunday in September I skipped the reading and paid for it on Tuesday with a decision I would not have made rested. These are not strategies. They are shelters.

Markets are weather. Portfolios are shelters. Neither makes promises. Records are all we keep.

In stillness, —

PIVOXQUANT RESEARCH DESK

SHARPE

*Observed at 0.91 over the window.
Not annualised into the future.*

TURNOVER

*41%. Monthly rebalance on the
last trading day, without
exception.*

WORST DAY

*Largest single-day drawdown
-3.2%, March 14. Book back at
prior high by the following
Wednesday.*

BOOK COMPOSITION

*Seven positions held through the
full year. Three entered mid-year.
Two closed in June.*

PART II · THE YEAR IN TWELVE

TWELVE MARKS ON A SINGLE ROPE

The book's equity walked month by month. The bronze mark names the best month; the faint red, the worst. Neither was forecast. Both were recorded.

FIG. 1 · MONTHLY EQUITY RIBBON · 2025

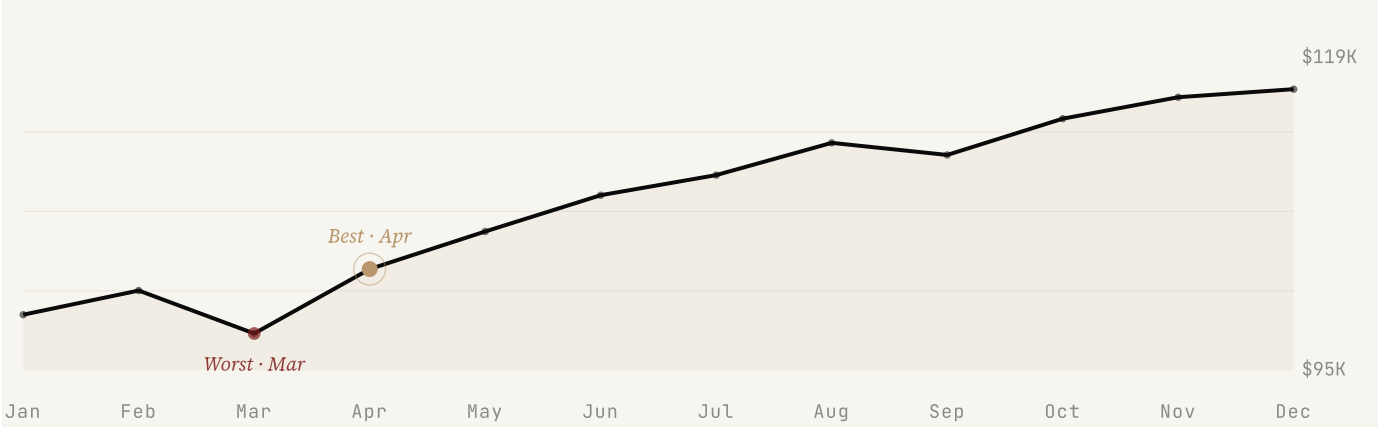
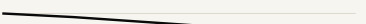
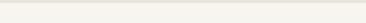
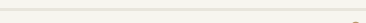
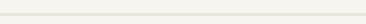


Fig. 1. Monthly equity on a \$100,000 seed, marked at the last trading day of each month. Bronze names the month of best P&L; faint red names the month of worst P&L.

MONTH	BOOK	SPY	ALPHA	DD	TRADES	TRAJECTORY
Jan	+1.8%	+0.9%	+0.9pp	-1.2%	5	
Feb	+1.8%	+1.4%	+0.4pp	-0.9%	4	
Mar	-3.1%	-1.8%	-1.3pp	-3.2%	7	
Apr	+4.8%	+2.6%	+2.2pp	-1.1%	3	
May	+2.7%	+1.8%	+0.9pp	-0.8%	4	
Jun	+2.5%	+1.4%	+1.1pp	-1.4%	6	
Jul	+1.4%	+1.2%	+0.2pp	-0.6%	2	
Aug	+2.2%	+0.8%	+1.4pp	-0.9%	3	
Sep	-0.8%	-1.4%	+0.6pp	-1.8%	5	
Oct	+2.4%	+1.4%	+1.0pp	-1.1%	4	
Nov	+1.4%	+1.1%	+0.3pp	-0.5%	2	
Dec	+0.5%	+0.8%	-0.3pp	-0.4%	1	

PART III · REFLECTIONS

FOUR CORNERS OF THE YEAR

Four short reflections, gathered at the close. What I kept. What I let go of. What I misread. What I am still watching. None is prescription.

I What I held onto

The positions I held through the year were held not because I was confident, but because the theses I had written down for them continued to describe the world I was in. Conviction is a noun that does poorly in public. Written theses age better.

- The semiconductor cohort — held on the operating-leverage thesis, which stayed intact.
- The platform cohort — trimmed once in July, otherwise left alone.
- Cash at a steady 9–11% through the year — not strategy, a shelter.

II What I let go of

Two positions were closed in June, both at small losses. Neither had produced a single print that surprised me on the upside for four months. I had kept them on the theory that quiet is a prelude. Quiet was just quiet.

- A mid-cap industrial whose customer-concentration note I had read and forgotten.
- A consumer name whose thesis required a margin expansion that never arrived.
- Two commentary subscriptions that, on review, added no signal beyond the news.

III What I got wrong

I read one position as a story of operating leverage and missed a footnote that was not hidden — only, I had read it once and not reread it. The position was closed at a small loss. The error worth naming is not the loss. It is the confidence. I had been sure.

- Over-weighting a thesis I had read once and treated as digested.
- Reading weekend research on Sunday evening rather than Saturday morning.
- Confusing a quiet six weeks with a constructive six weeks.

IV What I will keep watching

Nothing here is a plan for the coming year. The items below are things I mean to keep observing — not because observing them will produce a return, but because not observing them has, in the past, produced regret.

- Whether the semiconductor operating-leverage story survives a demand normalisation.
- Whether the quiet stretches of August–September recur and how I spend them.
- Whether the monthly-rebalance discipline survives a January without a print.

PART IV · EDITORIAL

THE SENTENCE THE DESK IS SITTING WITH

A single line held in mind at the close of the year, and the quiet catalogue of items a letter like this does not claim.

The year did not arrive. It was made, decision by small decision — most of them unremarkable, a few regrettable, none forecast.

— PIVOXQUANT · YEAR 2025 —

WHAT THIS LETTER DOES NOT CLAIM

- | | | | |
|----|-------------------------------------|----|--|
| 01 | A thesis for the coming year. | 04 | A guarantee of future observation quality. |
| 02 | A blueprint for replication. | 05 | Tax or legal guidance. |
| 03 | A professional service or advisory. | | |

Observational. Informational only. Not investment advice.

COLOPHON · DATA & RECORD

PRICE OBSERVATIONS Alpaca Market Data (IEX consolidated).

CORPORATE ACTIONS FMP v4 Stable.

RISK-FREE 3-Month T-Bill via FRED (DGS3MO).

BENCHMARK SPY total return, with dividends.

TYPESET IN Source Serif 4 · Geist · JetBrains Mono.

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